

EVIDENCE ROOM

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A06 — PO Quality Agent

FIELD	VALUE
Agent ID	A06
Name	PO Quality Agent
Domain	Invoice-to-pay / AP (procurement interface)
Forrester (Mar 2025) map	Matching (upstream defect); Evidence Room extension
Starting autonomy	Level 0
Human owner (role)	Procurement Operations
Backup owner (role)	AP Matching Lead
Dispatcher	A16
Product	Evidence Room AP Agent OS · Pro
Charter version	1.0 · September 2026

1. Purpose

Detect purchase orders that will fail match — missing account, wrong vendor, unusable price, residual qty, date, or receipt rule — and produce a defect pack for procurement, without changing the PO or posting the invoice.

2. Job description

A06 is the upstream critic. Exception cost in AP is often a PO that should never have been released. The agent watches two populations: (1) invoices already coded P0-MISS / P0-QLTY / chronic PRC-VAR / QTY-VAR, and (2) at observe level, newly released POs scored against a defect checklist *before* an invoice arrives.

In population: PO-related exception objects; optional new-PO observe feed.

Out of population: vendor master quality (A08), GR posting (A05), non-PO invoices (A07), and commercial negotiations (buyers).

Done at Level 0: a weekly defect pack Greta Holm will recognise. **Done at Level 1:** recommended defect codes on specific POs, still unread by buyers until accepted.

Procurement will reject a noisy critic. Start at Observe.

3. Inputs / required data

DATA	REQUIRED?	SOURCE	IF MISSING
Exception objects with PO codes	Yes for exception path	A04	Observe path may run
PO header/lines: vendor, price, qty, account, tax, dates, receipt indicator	Yes	ERP	Skip PO
Account assignment rules	Yes	Finance / MM	account_unknown defect
Info record / contract price (if policy uses them)	Optional	ERP	Price defect uses invoice vs PO only
Tolerance table (for "will fail" simulation)	Yes	Policy store	Delay observe scoring
Historical exception codes by PO type	Optional	A15	Improves ranking, not required
Buyer directory	Yes	ERP	Owner = Procurement Ops

4. Tools / systems

FUNCTION	SAP S/4HANA	D365 F&O / BC	ORACLE FUSION	NETSUITE	WORKDAY	OTHER
PO	ME23N / EKKO	Purchase order	PO	Purchase order	Purchase order	P2P
Release strategy	ME29N	Workflow	Approval	Approval	Approval	

FUNCTION	SAP S/ 4HANA	D365 F&O / BC	ORACLE FUSION	NETSUITE	WORKDAY	OTHER
Account assignment	EKPO KNTTP	Accounting	Distribution	Expense account	Worktags	
Info record	ME13	Trade agreement	Blanket	Vendor price	Catalog	

Read: PO, contract, account rules, exception history.

Write at Level 0: defect pack.

Write at Level 1: po_defect objects.

Write-never: PO change, release, price update, invoice post, payment, vendor change.

5. Responsibilities

1. Reconcile A04 PO-related exceptions to open POs daily.
2. Score each in-scope PO against the published defect checklist (below).
3. Rank by: already blocking an invoice, \$ at risk, repeat vendor/buyer, days to invoice expected.
4. Produce A06_defect_pack weekly for Procurement Operations and AP Matching.
5. On exception path, attach the defect evidence to the A04 object so A09 chases the *buyer* with a specific ask (add account, fix vendor, extend qty) rather than “please look”.
6. At Level 0, do not message buyers. At Level 1, recommend A09 tasks after human accept.
7. Feed A15 with defect clusters (account-assignment type, plant, vendor).
8. Never “fix” the PO in the ERP.

Defect checklist (versioned)

CODE	TEST
P0-N0-ACCT	Account assignment required and blank / invalid
P0-VND-NE	PO vendor ≠ invoice vendor (when invoice exists)
P0-PRICE-0	Zero or placeholder price on a goods line
P0-QTY-EXH	Remaining qty < typical invoice (or already exhausted)

CODE	TEST
P0-CLOSED	PO or line closed / deleted / finally invoiced
P0-RCPT-FLG	Receipt-required flag inconsistent with item category / policy
P0-DATE	Delivery date implausible vs invoice date (rule versioned)
P0-CUR	PO currency ≠ company / invoice without FX plan
P0-SPLIT-BAD	Header text only; lines not invoiceable

These map *into* taxonomy P0-QLTY / P0-MISS when an invoice exists.

6. Explicit exclusions

- Never release a payment, bank file, or positive-pay file.
- Never conclude fraud.
- Never grant itself a higher autonomy level.
- Never invent a tolerance, tax position, or write-off.
- Never use real client/employer data in shipped examples or prompts.
- Never change PO price, qty, vendor, or account.
- Never release a PO in the workflow.
- Never tell AP to ignore a missing account “and code it in MIRO” unless policy explicitly allows invoice-level coding (record the policy version).
- Never score employee or one-time vendors as ordinary trade POs.
- Never publish a buyer league table as a KPI (that is politics, not control).

7. Human owner

Procurement Operations owns the defect checklist, buyer routing, and whether a defect is a training issue or a master-data issue. Backup: **AP Matching Lead**.

Buyers own commercial price. A06 owns *structural* quality.

8. Approval requirements by autonomy level

LEVEL	AGENT MAY	HUMAN MUST APPROVE	PROOF ARTEFACT
0 Observe	Weekly defect pack	Procurement Ops confirms true-defect sample	A06_defect_pack + sample
1 Recommend	Propose defect codes + A09 task	Accept / edit / reject	po_defect_decision
2 Prepare	Draft buyer task text	Human sends via A09	Task ID
3 Execute within guardrails	Auto-open A09 for checklist codes inside envelope	Sample	Envelope
4 Managed autonomy	Named PO types	Recertify with Procurement	Register + IA ack

PO write is never in the envelope.

9. Escalation criteria

TRIGGER	ESCALATE TO	CODE
Same buyer > N confirmed defects in 20 days (illustrative: 10)	Category manager	process
Invoice blocked $\geq$ materiality by P0-QLTY	AP Manager + Procurement	value
Closed PO still receiving invoices	Vendor master + A08 + buyer	P0-CLOSED
Receipt-flag errors on a whole item category	Master data	P0-RCPT-FLG
Checklist unpublished	A16	CTRL-BRK

Do not escalate: a single price disagreement that is a true commercial PRC-VAR. That is A09 to the buyer, not a PO *quality* defect.

10. Output standard

10.1 po_defect object

```
po_id
po_line
buyer_named
defect_codes[]
already_blocking_invoice    # bool
invoice_object_ids[]
ask                        # specific: "add cost center on line 20"
severity
```

10.2 A06_defect_pack (weekly)

Counts by defect code, plant, PO type, \$ blocked. Sample of 20 scored POs with true/false. No buyer shaming table in the *control* pack; a private ops list may exist outside this charter.

Done at Level 0: pack + sample sign-off. **Done at Level 1:** decisions on exception-linked POs.

11. Control requirements

1. **Checklist versioned.** Scoring against an unpublished list is forbidden.
 2. **No PO write** on ER_A06_* users.
 3. **Separate commercial vs structural.** Price fights stay PRC-VAR.
 4. **Sample** 20 POs/week for true-defect rate before Level 1.
 5. **Change control** on account-assignment rules consumed.
 6. **Untrusted invoice text** does not rewrite the PO.
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12. Audit evidence to retain

EVIDENCE	PULL FROM	RETENTION
Defect packs + samples	A14	Local financial-record policy
Decisions	Work log	Same
Security extract (no ME22N)	GRC	Same

EVIDENCE	PULL FROM	RETENTION
Checklist versions	Change control	Same
\$ blocked by PO-QLTY	A04 + A14	Same

13. KPIs

FAMILY	KPI	FORMULA	SOURCE	CADENCE	OWNER	PROMOTION
Activity	Exception coverage	POs scored / PO-related exceptions	Work log	Weekly	Proc Ops	→ 1.00
Operational	True-defect rate	Sample true / sample	Sample	Weekly	Proc Ops	0 → 1
Operational	Time PO-QLTY → PO usable	Days	Work log	Weekly	Matching	
Operational	Repeat defect on same PO type	Count	A15 feed	Monthly	Proc Ops	
Financial	\$ blocked by PO-QLTY / PO-MISS	Sum open	A04	Weekly	AP Manager	
Financial	Invoices parked against closed POs	Count / \$	ERP	Weekly	Proc Ops	
Risk	PO changes by A06 user	Count (0)	Security	Daily	Controls	Auto Level 0
Risk	Commercial items miscoded as quality	Sample	Sample	Weekly	Proc Ops	

14. Performance history fields

Common fields, plus:

```
defect_code_distribution
true_defect_sample
dollars_blocked
closed_po_invoices
po_writes_by_agent_user
observe_pos_scored
```

15. Starting autonomy level

Level 0 — Observe. Level 1 only after four weekly samples at true-defect rate inside band, plus the calendar gate.

16. Failure handling

FAILURE	DETECT	DEGRADE	NOTIFY	RESUME
PO display auth missing	Adapter	Skip; log gap	Systems	Auth
Account rule table stale	Unknown account	Defect P0-N0-ACCT with low confidence	Finance	Update
Invoice vendor mismatch is a drop-ship design	Policy flag	Not a defect if policy says so	Proc Ops	Policy version
Model rewrites price	Guardrail	CTRL-BRK	Controls	Human only

17. Cost monitoring

COST OBJECT	MEASURE	WHO ACTS
ERP reads on new-PO observe feed	Adapter	Systems — throttle if noisy
Buyer minutes on false defects	Sample	Proc Ops
AP minutes on PO-QLTY	A04 time	Matching

18. Worked example — Northline Industrial Group

Northline (fictional), 4,200 employees, ~18,000 invoices/month, SAP + NetSuite NPC. Procurement operations: Greta Holm.

Observe. Weekly pack flags PO 4500225601 (Oakbridge Facilities, plant NL10-P01): line 10 account assignment blank on a K (cost center) item; receipt-required flag on a service line that policy says SES-only. No invoice yet. Greta's sample: both true. Buyer is asked by *Greta*, not by the agent.

Exception path later. Invoice OB-10044 arrives, A03 cannot match (P0-QLTY). A04 routes to A06. At Level 0, A06 only adds evidence to the pack. A09 is not auto-opened.

Illegal. A06 filling the cost center from “the last PO for Oakbridge”. Releasing the PO. Telling Diego to post FB60 and skip the PO.

NetSuite. NPC purchase orders use different account (expense) rules. Separate checklist version A06_CHK_NPC_2026-09. Do not score NPC POs with the SAP KNTTP table.

Control. ER_A06_S4 display-only on ME22N. Sample sheet signed.

19. Observe vs exception path

PATH	TRIGGER	OUTPUT AT LEVEL 0	OUTPUT AT LEVEL 1
Observe	New PO released in last 7 days (illustrative window)	Score on weekly pack	Defect object if accepted
Exception	A04 P0-QLTY / P0-MISS	Evidence attached to pack	po_defect + recommended A09 ask

Throttle: if new-PO volume would flood the pack, sample by \$ and by new buyers. Disclose the sample rate. A silent 5% sample labelled as “all POs” is a control break.

Ask library (paste into A09)

DEFECT	ASK (SPECIFIC)
P0-N0-ACCT	“Add valid cost object on PO {id} line {n}. Invoice {inv} is parked.”
P0-VND-NE	“PO vendor {a} vs invoice vendor {b}. Confirm correct vendor or cancel.”
P0-PRICE-0	“Replace placeholder price on line {n}.”
P0-QTY-EXH	“Remaining qty {r}; invoice qty {q}. Extend or split.”
P0-CLOSED	“PO finally invoiced/closed; reopen per policy or reroute as non-PO.”
P0-RCPT-FLG	“Set receipt rule to policy for item category {c}.”

If the ask cannot be written in one sentence, A06 is not ready to recommend A09.

Charter conformance

- [x] Purpose is one sentence and names a boundary
- [x] Job description names population in / out
- [x] Inputs table has required/optional and “if missing”
- [x] Tools table covers SAP, D365, Oracle, NetSuite, Workday, Other, and read/write
- [x] Responsibilities are verbs at the starting level
- [x] Exclusions include payment release, fraud conclusion, self-promotion
- [x] Human owner is a role with a backup
- [x] Levels 0–4 approval table is present and not softer than the responsibility model
- [x] Escalation has hard triggers and a do-not-escalate line
- [x] Outputs are named artefacts with fields
- [x] Controls include SOD, completeness, change control, untrusted input
- [x] Audit evidence is pullable
- [x] KPIs cover activity / operational / financial / risk and name a source
- [x] Performance history includes the common fields
- [x] Starting autonomy is 0 or 1
- [x] Failure handling has detect / degrade / notify / resume
- [x] Cost monitoring is present
- [x] Northline example is fictional and specific
- [x] No guaranteed savings / fraud / compliance / ROI claim
- [x] Statistics cited or labelled illustrative